

Document 13: Cancer - Definition and Types

Cancer is a group of diseases characterized by uncontrolled growth and spread of abnormal cells. If the spread is not controlled, it can result in death. Cancers are classified by the type of cell or organ affected, such as carcinoma (epithelial cells), sarcoma (connective tissue), leukemia (blood-forming tissues), and lymphoma (lymphatic system). Risk factors include tobacco use, infections, radiation, poor diet, and genetic predisposition. Early detection through screening and advances in surgery, chemotherapy, radiotherapy, and targeted therapies have improved survival rates for many cancers.